

Creative reuse

In its new embodiment, London's Tate Modern art museum (opposite) is a successful example of creative reuse in architecture – also called adaptive reuse or architectural conservation. Formerly Bankside Power Station and built originally in 1891, the building became redundant a century later and was destined for demolition until British writer and architectural historian Gavin Stamp (b.1948) made a plea for it to be saved. Across the world, increasingly, structures that no longer serve their original purpose are being reused creatively through the application of new methods and materials. Although it is often more cost-effective to demolish a building and replace it, heritage is taken into account. Creative reuse can involve approaches ranging from reconstruction, restoration and conservation to radical new structural additions. The Pratt Street Power Plant in Baltimore, USA, was closed in 1973 but reworked for the 21st century into shops, restaurants and offices. In Duisburg, Germany, the Thyssen Steelworks was reinvented by Latz + Partner in 1999 as a public leisure space.

